

016. Chapter 2 Verses 45-47

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.45

त्रैगुण्यविषया वेदा निस्त्रैगुण्यो भवार्जुन ।
निर्द्वन्द्वो नित्यसत्त्वस्थो निर्योगक्षेम आत्मवान् ॥ 45 ॥

traiguṇyaviṣayā vedā
nistraiguṇyo bhavārjuna |
nirdvandvo nityasattvastho
niryogakṣema ātmavān ||

◆ traiguṇya-viṣayāḥ – dealing with the three Gunas; vedāḥ – the Vedas; ◆
nistraiguṇyaḥ – free from the three Gunas; bhava – be; arjuna – O Arjuna; ◆
nirdvandvaḥ – free from dualities; nitya-sattva-sthaḥ – established in eternal
Truth (Sattva); ◆ nir-yoga-kṣemaḥ – free from (the thought of) acquisition and
preservation; ātmavān – self-possessed.

The first part of the Vedas (Karma Kanda) deal with material things pertaining to the three Gunas. One should transcend the three Gunas, become free from the operation of the pairs of opposites, take refuge in the pure sattvic state, and firmly establish himself in Atma.

VERSE 2.46

यावानर्थ उदपाने सर्वतः सम्प्लुतोदके ।
तावान्सर्वेषु वेदेषु ब्राह्मणस्य विजानतः ॥ 46 ॥

yāvānārtha udapāne
sarvataḥ samplutodake |
tāvānsarveṣu vedeṣu
brāhmaṇasya vijānataḥ ||

◆ yāvān – as much; arthaḥ – use; uda-pāne – in a small reservoir of water; ◆
sarvataḥ – everywhere; sampluta-udake – being flooded with water; ◆ tāvān –
so much; sarveṣu – in all; vedeṣu – in the Vedas; ◆ brāhmaṇasya – for a
Brahmana; vijānataḥ – who knows (the Truth).

**To an enlightened person who has known the Self, all the
Vedas are of as much use as is a reservoir of water in a place
where there is a flood.**

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

karmaṇyevādhikāraṣte
mā phaleṣu kadācana |
mā karmaphalāheturbhūr
mā te saṅgo'stvakarmaṇi ||

◆ karmaṇi – in action; eva – only; adhikāraḥ – right; te – your; ◆ mā – never; phaleṣu – in fruits; kadācana – at any time; ◆ mā – not; karma-phala-hetuḥ – cause of the fruit of action; bhūḥ – be; ◆ mā – not; te – your; saṅgaḥ – attachment; astu – let there be; akarmaṇi – in inaction.

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.